

Week 2 Lab Meeting

Summer 2026



Deviations

- What happened this week?
- What did you do?
- Any suggestions to improve the system?

Other logistics

- No-show protocol
- Concert advertisement

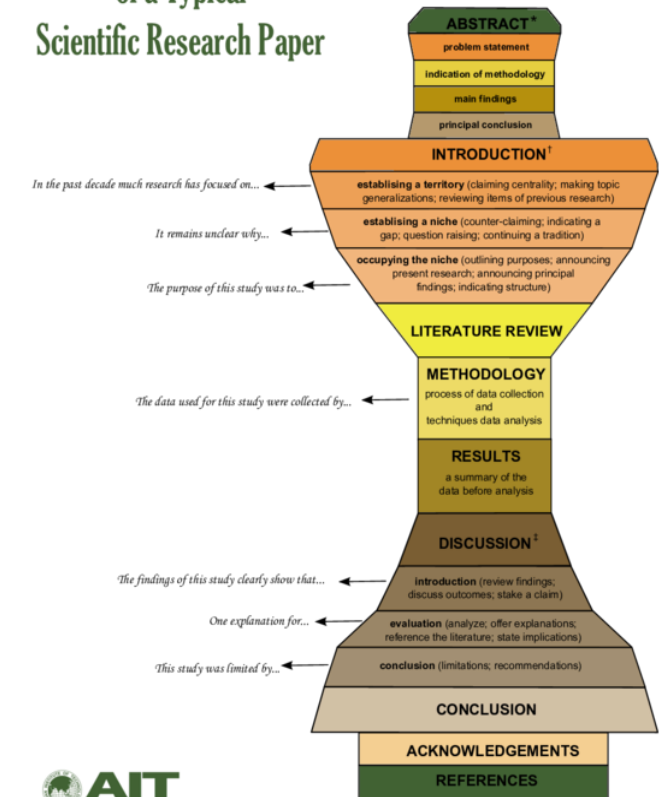


How to Read an Article

- Most empirical papers follow:
 - *Introduction: Why does this matter?*
 - *Methods: What did they do?*
 - *Results: What did they find?*
 - *Discussion: What does it mean?*

The Hourglass Structure of a Typical Scientific Research Paper

AIT Language Center



* Bland, J. R. (1985). *Abstracting papers: A practical guide to writing abstracts*. New York: Springer.

† Deane, M. (1971). *Basic of writing papers: A practical guide to writing abstracts*. London: Heinemann.

‡ Bland, J. R. (1985). *Abstracting papers: A practical guide to writing abstracts*. New York: Springer.

§ Bland, J. R. (1985). *Abstracting papers: A practical guide to writing abstracts*. New York: Springer.

¶ Bland, J. R. (1985). *Abstracting papers: A practical guide to writing abstracts*. New York: Springer.

|| Bland, J. R. (1985). *Abstracting papers: A practical guide to writing abstracts*. New York: Springer.

Empirical Paper vs. Review Paper

- Empirical paper:
 - *Collects and analyzes new data*
- Review paper:
 - *Summarizes existing studies*
- Meta-analysis:
 - *Statistically combines results across studies*

What Are Activity-Permissive Workstations?

- Sit-stand desks
- Standing desks
- Treadmill desks
- Cycling/pedal desks
- Stepping devices

Are these all the same intervention?

What are the main findings?
What surprised you?



Walk and Talk!

Small Samples, Big Claims?

- Average study size: about 27 people
- Range: 2 to 66 people
- What problems come from small samples?

Heterogeneity: The Field Is Messy

- $I^2 = 91\%$ (The studies varied a lot!)
- Why might APW studies produce different effects?

Does APW Work?

For whom, doing what task, using which workstation, for how long?

How does this change the way we think about SWaT?

What Does “No Significant Health Effect” Mean?

Does that mean APWs do not affect health?

What counts as “work performance”?

- Work outcomes were mostly unchanged, but some worsened.
- Possible issues:
 - *Typing speed*
 - *Mouse use*
 - *Spreadsheets*
 - *Fine motor tasks*
 - *Adjustment period*

Feasibility

- Lab acceptability
- Real-world feasibility
- Long-term maintenance

*What Claims Can SWaT
Claim?*

*What would be the next study
after SWaT?*